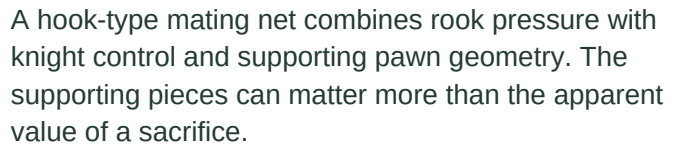


Hook mating nets

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Identify the final checking line and then trace which friendly pieces protect the attacker and control the king's exits.

The defending king is on f2. Geometrically undefended: rook on c7 and rook on h6. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 47.Kf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

47...Rf1#

47...Rf1# Mate: rook on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on f2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.